



A VECTOR-BORNE DISEASE TRAINING AND EVALUATION CENTER

Extension Materials Analysis Tool – Scoring Guide

How to use this guide

Rate each statement Poor = 1, Fair = 2, Acceptable = 3, or Excellent = 4. The specific criteria for choosing each rating are listed below by category. This guide is tailored for public health outreach on vector-borne disease safety (e.g., ticks and tick-borne diseases, mosquitoes and mosquito-borne diseases).

Standards

Focus: spelling, grammar, ~6th-grade readability, target audience identified, appropriate language/graphics, trusted source, problem identified, and pathways for more information.

Excellent (4)

- No spelling or grammatical errors; plain-language at ~6th-grade reading level; visuals and terminology are audience-appropriate.
- Target audience and problem are explicit and prominent; trusted source clearly identified (agency/program/author).
- Clear pathway for more information (e.g., URL/QR/contact) is obvious and functional.

Acceptable (3)

- Only minor, non-disruptive errors; readability roughly 6th–8th grade; mostly appropriate visuals/terms.
- Audience and problem are apparent but not emphasized; source is credible but less prominent.
- At least one working path for more information is present.

Fair (2)

- Several errors or inconsistent readability (too technical or uneven); occasional jargon; visuals inconsistently appropriate.
- Audience or problem is vague; source credibility is unclear or not well labeled.
- “More info” path is weak, missing context, or easy to overlook.

Poor (1)

- Frequent spelling/grammar errors; readability inappropriate (too technical or confusing); visuals poorly matched to audience.
- Lacks clear audience and problem; no credible or identifiable source.
- No clear way to obtain additional information or help.

Content Development

Focus: accuracy; right amount of information; simple solution; clear HOW/WHEN/WHERE to act; reason/cause for actions.

Excellent (4)

- Accurate, current, and concise; scope is “right-sized” for the audience (no overload).
- Specific HOW, WHEN, and WHERE steps (e.g., apply insect repellent before outdoor activity; reapply as directed; wear long pants in tick habitats; check for ticks after yard work).
- Strong rationale for recommendations with plain-language evidence provided.

Acceptable (3)

- Generally accurate, perhaps with minor omissions; scope is reasonable.
- Covers most of HOW/WHEN/WHERE with clear but brief steps.
- Rationale is present but could be more explicit or better supported.

Fair (2)

- Some inaccuracies; information is thin or unfocused (or, alternatively, information overload).
- Steps are generic or incomplete.
- Rationale is weak or not tied to the recommended actions.

Poor (1)

- Inaccurate or misleading content.
- No clear, actionable steps; or some steps are missing or contradictory.
- No reasoning for recommendations.

Targeted Messaging

Focus: accessibility, cultural relevance, visuals reflecting target audience/area, community-trusted source.

Excellent (4)

- Accessible format (clear language, adequate font/contrast).
- Cultural and regional relevance (examples, imagery, and scenarios that reflect the audience’s context); translations provided if needed.
- Created or endorsed by community-trusted sources with visible co-branding.

Acceptable (3)

- Generally accessible; minor improvements possible (e.g., slightly dense language or small type).
- Visuals/scenarios are mostly relevant; some generic elements.
- Credible source is clear, though community connection could be stronger.

Fair (2)

- Accessibility gaps (dense text, low contrast, limited headings, missing alt-text).
- Visuals are generic or misaligned with the audience.
- Source credibility is indirect or not emphasized.

Poor (1)

- Not accessible (hard-to-read design, jargon-heavy language, no logical structure).
- Culturally insensitive or misaligned visuals/messages.
- No trusted source identified.

Visual Design

Focus: clarity and organization; visual appeal; effective graphics/icons; concise and focused; originality aligned with purpose.

Excellent (4)

- Clear information, distinct topics separated by white/blank space; color, font, overall style are consistent and legible in print and on screen. Care taken to avoid red-green patterns that would be hard for colorblind people to decipher.
- Graphics/icons improve understanding (e.g., tick removal steps, mosquito life-cycle diagram) without clutter.
- Concise, focused messaging; layout guides the eye to key actions.

Acceptable (3)

- Mostly clean layout; occasional crowding.
- Graphics generally helpful but may lack uniform style or optimal placement.
- Some text could be tighter, but the main message is clear.

Fair (2)

- Uneven organization; weak contrast/alignment; crowded or sparse sections.
- Graphics are underused, distracting, or poorly integrated with text.
- Unfocused; key actions are hard to identify.

Poor (1)

- Disorganized, cluttered, or hard to read; inconsistent fonts/colors.
- Little to no meaningful visual support.

Action Based

Focus: specific, achievable actions that minimize harm/fear and can be measured and evaluated.

Excellent (4)

- Specific, feasible behaviors (e.g., remove standing water weekly; repair screens; wear permethrin-treated clothing; apply DEET or picaridin as directed; conduct tick checks).
- Low barriers (common, accessible materials); promotes self-efficacy and safety (e.g., proper repellent use, child/pet considerations).
- Measurable follow-up (checklists, frequency goals, or simple self-monitoring prompts).

Acceptable (3)

- Actions are clear and generally feasible; minor barriers (cost, availability, time) are acknowledged.
- Encourages confidence; provides some safety notes.
- Some measure of frequency (e.g., “weekly” or “after outdoor activity”) but could be more explicit.

Fair (2)

- Actions are vague or not entirely feasible (require uncommon items or complex steps).
- Limited attention to safety or user confidence.
- Weak guidance on frequency and how to track/assess completion.

Poor (1)

- Unrealistic, risky, or fear-inducing recommendations.
- Requires hard-to-obtain materials or specialized skills.
- No way to evaluate if the action was done or effective.